

## Episode 2: The Well of Betrayal

Based on Qur'an, Surah Yusuf (12) : 7-20

The jealousy of Yusuf's brothers finally reached its peak. They said to one another, "Joseph and his brother are more beloved to our father than we, while we are a clan. Indeed, our father is in clear error" (Qur'an 12:8). Some proposed killing Yusuf, but one of them suggested another path: "Do not kill Joseph but throw him into the bottom of the well; some travelers will pick him up" (12:10).

Through deception, they persuaded Ya'qub to let Yusuf go with them, promising to protect him (12:11-12). Ya'qub, heavy-hearted and anxious, ultimately agreed (12:13). Along the way, they threw Yusuf into the well. But Allah did not abandon him — "We revealed to him, 'You will surely inform them [someday] about this affair of theirs while they do not perceive [your identity]'" (12:15).

His brothers returned weeping in feigned grief, carrying Yusuf's shirt stained with false blood, claiming a wolf had eaten him (12:16-18). Ya'qub, in his wisdom, was not entirely convinced, and said, "So patience is most fitting. And Allah is the one sought for help against that which you describe" (12:18).

Meanwhile, a caravan of travelers found Yusuf in the well, took him as merchandise, and sold him for a very low price (12:19-20).

Reflection: Ya'qub's beautiful patience (sabr jamil) models how to face great calamity without ever despairing of Allah's mercy.

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